Testing the timeline, step by step

You'll play a coordinator who receives six client estimates in a row and turns each one into a project. After each one you check that the app planned it sensibly. You can't break anything: it all runs in a practice copy of the app.

What's in this part

A–D	**Setup** (once, about 15 minutes)
1	Northwind Bakery: a small website
2	Northwind phase 2: sharing work out
3	Cedar Clinic: senior-only work
4	Lakeside Gym: someone on vacation
5	Harbor Realty: Thanksgiving
6	Pine & Co: starting on Christmas Day

Each scenario takes 5–10 minutes. Do them **in order, in one sitting**: each project keeps people busy for the next one. Part 2 (scenarios 7–12) continues in the same browser.

How every scenario page works

DO	Numbered steps. Do them top to bottom. Purple words are buttons or tabs to click; `grey boxes` are text to type.
CHECK	What you should see. Tick each box.
WRITE DOWN	Copy one or two dates from the screen.
OPTIONAL	An extra test. Skip it if you're short on time.

Five words you'll see

- **Day 1**: the first weekday on or after the day you're testing. If you test on a Tuesday, Day 1 is that Tuesday; Day 2 is Wednesday.
- **Best-fit**: give each task to the most skilled person, even if they're busy.
- **Fastest**: give each task to whoever can finish it soonest.
- **Work key**: what a person is allowed to do, e.g. "IT Level 2". Level 2 is senior and can also take Level 1 work; Level 1 can't take Level 2.
- **"after 17h already booked"**: that person had 17 hours of earlier work, so this task waits behind it.

SETUP · DO THIS ONCE

Get the practice app ready

Four short stages. When you finish D, everyone on the team is free and set up the same way the expected results assume.

A Open the practice copy

Why not the real app? In the real app, starting a project creates a real deal in Zoho and a real purchase order in billing, and billing can't delete one. The practice copy (called **Demo**) plans exactly the same way but keeps everything in your browser.

1. If the app is already running in a terminal, stop it (click the terminal, press **Ctrl + C**).
2. Open **Git Bash** in the project folder (not PowerShell) and paste:
   `NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL= NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY= npx next dev -p 3001`
3. When it says "Ready", open `http://localhost:3001/dashboard` in Chrome.
4. Top left, next to "Timeline Estimator", the badge must say **Demo**. If it says **Live**, close the tab and ask for help.

B Empty the sample data

1. Bottom left, in your name card, change the role dropdown to **Admin**.
2. Click **Projects**. Delete all four sample projects: open each one's ⋯ menu → **Delete** → confirm.
3. Click **Workload** → **Team**. Everyone should show **0 h** of open work.
4. Click **Settings** → **Time off** → **Team time off**. Delete both sample entries (Martin's "Annual leave" and Arvin's "Morning only").

C Set up the team

Click **Team**. For each person, click the ☆ button on their row → **Work keys & skills**, make it match the table, then **Close**.

PERSON	WORK KEY(S)	STAR RATING TO SET
Daniel	IT · Level 2	WordPress ★5 (already set)
Ronel	IT · Level 1	WordPress **★3** (change from ★4)
Arvin	IT · Level 1	WordPress ★4 (already set)
Patrick	IT · Level 2	**Add** WordPress ★4
Martin	Creative · Level 2	leave as is
Francis Jan	QA Tester · Level 1 **and** Project Manager · Level 1	**Add** Quality Assurance ★4

Ignore all other skills: only the ones in the table matter for these tests.

D Hours and holidays

1. **Workload** → **Team**: set Ronel's weekly hours to `32`. Everyone else stays at 40, except Martin at 20.
2. **Settings** → **Workspace** → **Holidays**: all eleven should say **Day off**.

Setup done. Projects list empty, Estimator list empty, everyone at 0 h, badge says Demo.

READ ONCE BEFORE SCENARIO 1

Three things you'll do in every scenario

1 · Create an estimate and add its lines

1. **Estimator** → **New estimate**. Type the title and client from the scenario page; platform stays **WordPress**. Click **Create and open**.
2. You land on **Line items**. There's one empty starter row: **use it for the first line**.
3. For each line: type the **title**, open the row's details, set **Role** and **Base hours**. Leave Tier on Basic and Qty on 1.
4. For the next line, click **Add row** and repeat.

A row without a title doesn't become a task, so don't leave the starter row empty.

2 · Look at the plan

1. Click the **Adjust** tab. Find the card **Who does the work**.
2. Pick **Best-fit** or **Fastest**, as the scenario says. The card shows the **launch date**.
3. Click **See who does what**: every task with its person and dates.

3 · Turn it into a project

1. Top right, change the status to **Approved**.
2. Click **Start project** → **Review schedule**. It should match what you saw on the Adjust tab.
3. Click **Confirm & create**. The project now exists, and its people are busy for the next scenario.

Glance at these every time

You don't need to write these down. Just stop and note it if one looks wrong.

- [ ] No task starts or ends on a **weekend** or a **holiday**.
- [ ] One person never has **two tasks at the same time**.
- [ ] **QA** (testing) comes after the building work, not before.
- [ ] **IT Level 2** work only ever goes to **Daniel or Patrick**.

Something looks wrong? Write down the scenario number, the person, the task and the dates shown, and take a screenshot of **See who does what**. Then carry on with the next step.

1 Northwind Bakery: a small website

You're checking that **the most skilled person gets the work and starts on Day 1**.

DO

Title `S1 Northwind Bakery`

Client `Northwind Bakery`

LINE TITLE	ROLE	BASE HOURS
Homepage build	IT · Level 1	8
About & Services pages	IT · Level 1	6
Contact form	IT · Level 1	3
QA pass	QA Tester · Level 1	4

1. Create the estimate and add the four lines.
2. **Adjust** → pick **Best-fit** → **See who does what**.
3. Set the status to **Approved**. The card locks and now says "Quoted launch".
4. **Start project** → **Review schedule** → **Confirm & create**.

CHECK

TASK	SHOULD GO TO	WHEN
Homepage build	Daniel	Day 1
About & Services pages	Daniel	Day 2
Contact form	Daniel	Day 2 → Day 3
QA pass	Francis Jan	Day 3 or later

- [ ] Daniel gets all the IT work: he has the most stars (★5), and Best-fit only cares about skill.
- [ ] The homepage starts on **Day 1**, not Day 2.
- [ ] **Workload** → **Team**: Daniel **17 h**, Francis **4 h**, everyone else 0 h.

WRITE DOWN

Launch date

Result: ○ Pass ○ Fail

2 Northwind phase 2: sharing work out

You're checking that **Fastest spreads work across free people**, while Best-fit piles it on the best one.

DO

Title `S2 Northwind Phase 2`

Client `Northwind Bakery`

LINE TITLE	ROLE	BASE HOURS
Blog setup	IT · Level 1	8
Menu page	IT · Level 1	6
Gallery	IT · Level 1	3
QA pass 2	QA Tester · Level 1	4

1. Create the estimate and add the four lines.
2. **Adjust** → **Best-fit** → **See who does what**. Everything goes to Daniel, "after 17h already booked". Write down the launch date.
3. Switch to **Fastest**. Write down the launch date again: same or earlier.
4. Leave it on **Fastest**. Approve → **Start project** → **Review schedule** → **Confirm & create**.

CHECK (with Fastest)

TASK	SHOULD GO TO	WHEN
Blog setup	Arvin	Day 1
Menu page	Patrick	Day 1
Gallery	Ronel	Day 1
QA pass 2	Francis Jan	after the building work

- [ ] Three people work at the same time on Day 1. Daniel gets nothing: he's still busy with scenario 1.
- [ ] **Workload** → **Team**: Daniel 17 h, Arvin 8 h, Patrick 6 h, Ronel 3 h, Francis 8 h.

WRITE DOWN

Launch with Best-fit	Launch with Fastest

Result: ○ Pass ○ Fail

3 Cedar Clinic: senior-only work

You're checking that **Level 2 work never goes to a Level 1 person**, even one who is free.

DO

Title `S3 Cedar Clinic Portal`

Client `Cedar Clinic`

LINE TITLE	ROLE	BASE HOURS
Patient login	**IT · Level 2**	16
Appointment page	IT · Level 1	4
QA pass 3	QA Tester · Level 1	3

1. Create the estimate and add the three lines.
2. **Adjust** → **Fastest** → **See who does what**.
3. Approve → **Start project** → **Review schedule** → **Confirm & create**.

CHECK

TASK	SHOULD GO TO	WHEN
Patient login (Level 2)	Patrick	Day 1 → Day 3
Appointment page	Arvin	Day 2
QA pass 3	Francis Jan	after the login work

- [ ] The Level 2 task went to **Daniel or Patrick**, never Ronel or Arvin.
- [ ] **Workload** → **Team**: Daniel 17 h, Patrick 22 h, Arvin 12 h, Ronel 3 h, Francis 11 h.

OPTIONAL **Do this between steps 2 and 3**

On **Team**, set Patrick's IT key to **None**, then go back to the estimate. The login task should move to **Daniel**, not to Ronel or Arvin. **Set Patrick back to IT · Level 2** before you approve.

WRITE DOWN

Who got the Level 2 task

Result: ○ Pass ○ Fail

4 Lakeside Gym: someone on vacation

You're checking that **nobody gets work on a vacation day**, and their work picks up after it.

DO

1. **First, book Daniel's vacation.** **Settings** → **Time off** → **Team time off** → choose **Daniel** → **Add for Daniel**. Type: **PTO / vacation**. Start: **next Monday**. End: **next Friday**. Save.

Daniel's vacation: from ____ to ____

Title `S4 Lakeside Gym`

Client `Lakeside Gym`

LINE TITLE	ROLE	BASE HOURS
Homepage	IT · Level 1	12
Class schedule	IT · Level 1	10
Membership page	IT · Level 1	6
QA pass 4	QA Tester · Level 1	4

2. Create the estimate and add the four lines.
3. **Adjust** → **Best-fit** → **See who does what**. Write down the launch date.
4. Switch to **Fastest**. Write down the launch date again.
5. Pick whichever you prefer. Approve → **Start project** → **Review schedule** → **Confirm & create**.

CHECK

- [ ] With Best-fit, all IT work goes to Daniel, behind his scenario 1 work.
- [ ] **None** of Daniel's tasks are dated inside his vacation week. A task that reaches it stops, and carries on the Monday after.
- [ ] With Fastest, the work is shared out and the launch date is earlier.
- [ ] **Calendar** → **Team**: Daniel's vacation shows, with no task of his on those days.

WRITE DOWN

Launch with Best-fit

Launch with Fastest

Result: ○ Pass ○ Fail

5 Harbor Realty: Thanksgiving

You're checking that a **questionnaire estimate** runs in the right order and **skips Thanksgiving**.

> This one uses the questionnaire instead of typing lines. If Thanksgiving 2026 has already passed, use start date **2027-02-08** and check **Mon 2027-02-15** (Presidents' Day) instead.

DO

1. **New estimate**: title `S5 Harbor Realty`, client `Harbor Realty`.
2. Click the **Scope & risk** tab → **Start guided scoping**.
3. Section **2 Scope & Structure**: Total Pages `6`, Unique Templates `2`. Answer **No** to everything else.
4. Sections **4, 5, 6 and 8**: untick **Include this section in the estimate** on each.
5. Section **7 Timeline**: Project Start Date `2026-11-23`, review turnaround `0`.
6. Click **Generate line items**, then **Adjust** → **Best-fit** → **See who does what**.
7. Approve → **Start project** → **Review schedule** → **Confirm & create**.

CHECK

- [ ] **Timeline** tab: the chart mentions **Thanksgiving**, and nothing starts or ends on **Thu Nov 26**. (Fri Nov 27 is a normal working day.)
- [ ] The right people: planning → **Francis Jan**, design → **Martin** (slow: 4 h a day), building → IT people, testing → **Francis Jan**.
- [ ] Design comes before building; nothing starts before Nov 23.
- [ ] The new project has no **Content** or **SEO** sprint (you switched those off).

WRITE DOWN

Launch date

Result: ○ Pass ○ Fail

6 Pine & Co: starting on Christmas Day

You're checking that a start date **on a day off moves to the next working day**.

DO

1. **New estimate**: title `S6 Pine & Co`, client `Pine & Co`.
2. **Scope & risk** → **Start guided scoping**. Answer it **the same as scenario 5** (6 pages, 2 templates, sections 4, 5, 6, 8 off).
3. Section **7**: Project Start Date `2026-12-25` (Christmas, a Friday).
4. **Generate line items** → **Adjust** → **Fastest**.
5. Open the **Timeline** tab and look at the first bar.
6. Try two more start dates in section 7: `2026-12-26` (Saturday), then `2026-12-28`. Then set it back to `2026-12-25`.
7. Approve → **Start project** → **Review schedule** → **Confirm & create**.

CHECK

- [ ] The first bar starts **Mon Dec 28**, not Dec 25.
- [ ] Dec 26 and Dec 28 give the **same** plan as Dec 25.
- [ ] Nothing starts or ends on **Fri Jan 1** (New Year's Day).
- [ ] In Review schedule, no task is dated Dec 25, 26, 27 or Jan 1.

WRITE DOWN

First bar starts	Launch date

Result: ○ Pass ○ Fail

Part 1 done. You should have six projects. Carry on with **Part 2** in the same browser. Don't clear anything in between: scenarios 7–12 build on this work.